



Cortical EEG slowing in resting-state Parkinson's disease

Final presentation: model, code, and findings

PD EEG group · Rui, Jan, Melissa, Friedrich · 26.06.2026

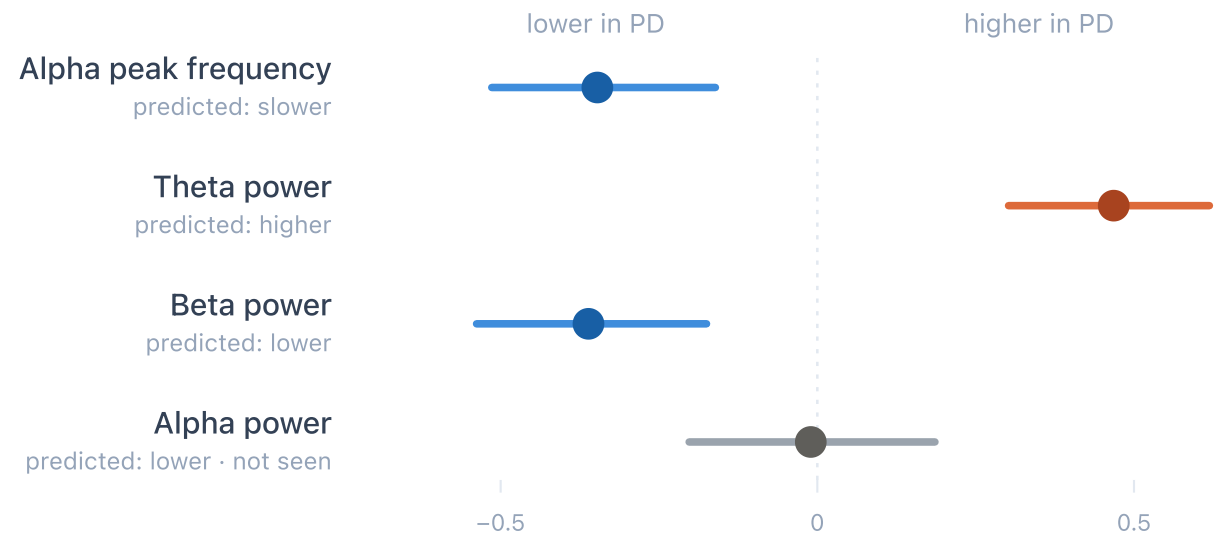
Hypotheses

Compared to age-matched healthy controls, Parkinson's patients at rest show:

- slowing of the alpha peak frequency (8 to 13 Hz)
- increased theta-band power (4 to 8 Hz)
- decreased cortical beta-band power (13 to 30 Hz)

How Parkinson's changes the resting EEG

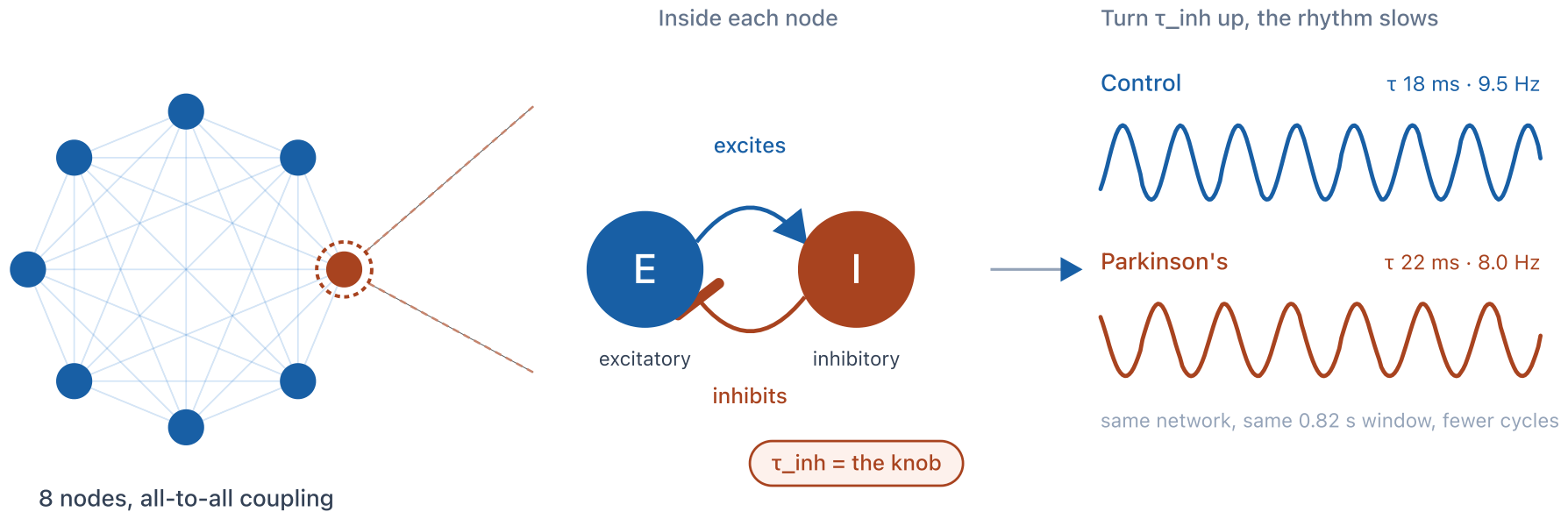
effect size per feature, with 95% confidence interval



The model: a Wilson-Cowan network

Modelling the slowing: a Wilson-Cowan network

8 coupled cortical nodes, each an excitatory-inhibitory loop. τ_{inh} is the only knob we turn.



The final adaptation from healthy to patient is a single parameter: a longer inhibitory time constant τ_{inh} , about **+3.25 ms** in PD.

Code & repository

THE CODE

1

Fit each subject
src/fitting.py

`tau = invert_peak_curve(alpha_peak, ...)`
tau from each subject's alpha peak

2

Build the model
src/model.py

`model = build_network(..., tau_inh=tau)`
one number = healthy vs patient

3

Compare groups
src/stats.py

`compare_groups(..., alternative="less")`
one-sided test: PD tau higher

one command, the actual result

```
bash
$ python scripts/05_compare_tau.py
PD vs Control: +3.25 ms, p = 0.0002
$ python scripts/06_recover_tau.py
unbiased, recovery error 0.5 ms
```

THE REPOSITORY

6

pipeline steps

4

modules

46

commits

149

subjects

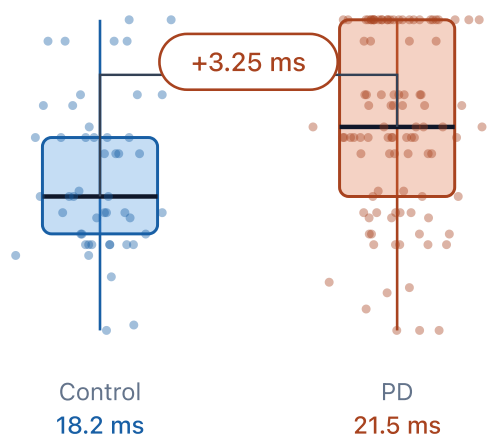
Everyone merges into main



Does the model separate patients from controls?

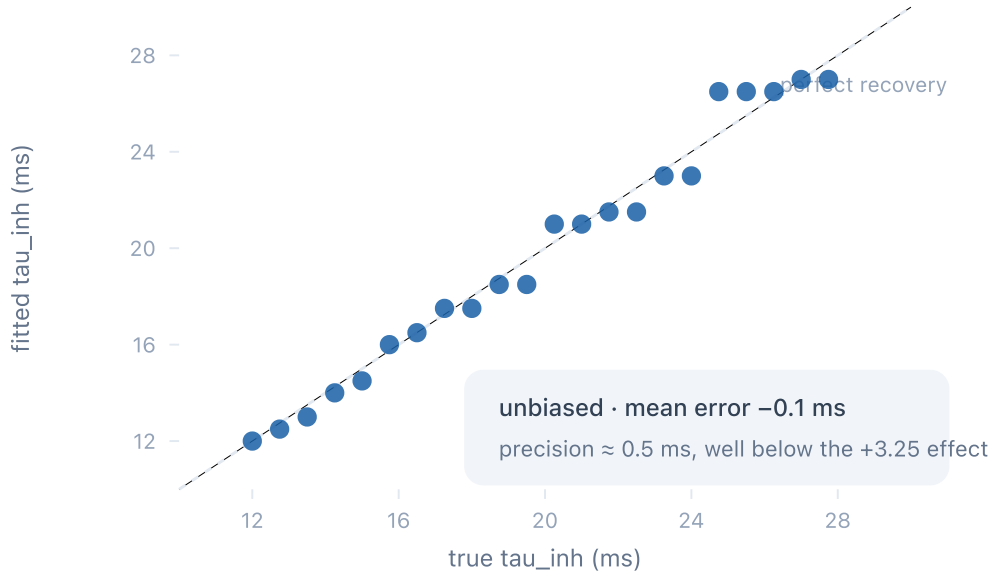
Fitted inhibitory time constant

the model parameter we change for a patient
fitting recovers tau to ± 0.5 ms, far below this group gap



Validation: recovering a known parameter

simulate at a known tau, fit it back



Fitted τ_{inh} is **+3.25 ms** higher in PD (one-sided Mann-Whitney, $p \approx 0.0002$). The recovery test shows this is a real separation, not an artefact of the fitting.

Outlook and open challenges

CURRENT CHALLENGES

- One parameter (τ_{inh}) reproduces the alpha slowing, but not the theta and beta changes
- The fit re-expresses the data-level effect, rather than adding independent evidence

FUTURE DIRECTIONS

- Fit more than the peak (full spectrum or functional connectivity), on a real connectome
- Relate fitted τ to clinical scores and to known inhibitory (GABAergic) changes in PD

What we took away

Rui [your biggest learning]

Jan [your biggest learning]

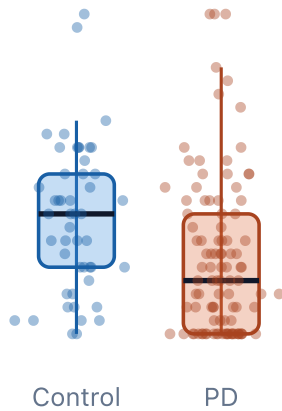
Melissa [your biggest learning]

Friedrich [your biggest learning]

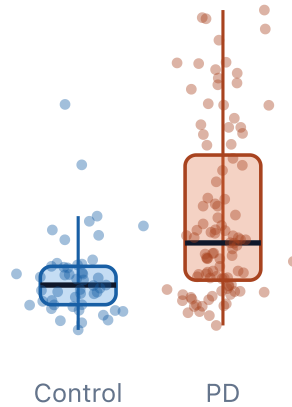
Appendix: per-subject distributions

PD vs Control: per-subject EEG features

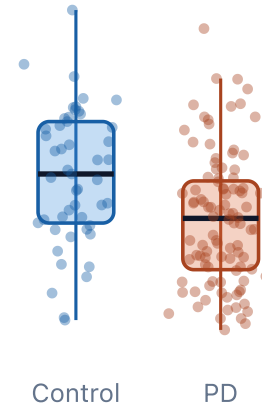
Alpha peak frequency
slower in PD



Theta power
higher in PD



Beta power
lower in PD



Alpha power
unchanged

